

Inwoo Lee

GEOPOLITICAL & AI POLICY ANALYST

Bloomington, IN, USA (Available to relocate)

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Summary

Geopolitical and technology analyst specializing in U.S.-China strategic competition, with a focus on AI policy, information operations, and frontier technology rivalry. Brings six-plus years spanning government-commissioned policy research and doctoral scholarship in political science, combining Mandarin-language primary source analysis with empirical methods including BERTopic topic modeling, LLM-assisted classification, and regression-based text analysis to produce decision-relevant intelligence for government and institutional stakeholders. Led 30 commissioned policy projects for ROK government ministries and international institutions; research framework adopted by Korea's Institute for National Security Strategy (INSS) to define national strategic technology policy. Track 1.5/II dialogue experience including Peking University and National Chengchi University provides direct access to research networks shaping China's frontier AI trajectory and geopolitical strategy.

KEY SKILLS

- **Research & Intelligence Analysis:** U.S.-China Strategic Competition, AI & Frontier Technology Policy, Geopolitical Risk Assessment, Nation-State Threat Assessment, Foreign Information Operations, Data Governance, OSINT, Structured Analytic Techniques, Horizon Scanning, Executive Intelligence Briefing
- **Technical Methods:** Python (NLP), R (Statistical Modeling), Topic Modeling (BERTopic, LDA, NMF), LLM-assisted Semantic Classification, Multi-model LLM Comparative Analysis, Regression Modeling, Data Visualization
- **Languages:** Korean (Native), English (Fluent), Mandarin (Proficient; primary source analysis)

Work Experience

Indiana University Bloomington

Bloomington, IN, USA

ASSOCIATE INSTRUCTOR

Aug 2023 - May 2026

- Conducted doctoral research on Chinese information environment dynamics, applying NLP, BERTopic, and regression-based methods to examine LLM ideological divergence across AI governance regimes, disinformation narrative competition, and Chinese influence operation patterns targeting Western audiences; completed M.S. in Applied Statistics (2026), deepening quantitative foundations for empirical research on AI competition.
- Designed and delivered 6 undergraduate political science courses, managing end-to-end curriculum design, performance evaluation, and individualized academic feedback; mentored an average 100 students per semester on research design, data analysis, and analytical writing.

Korea Economic Cooperation Institute (KECI)

Seoul, Korea

RESEARCH ASSOCIATE

Feb 2023 - Jul 2023

- Designed and maintained a cross-domain socioeconomic and security research database on the Korean Peninsula for senior officials at the Ministry of Economy and Finance, synthesizing open-source materials under severe information constraints; dataset referenced by government agencies for strategic policy analysis.
- Produced monthly policy briefs and annual strategic assessments on inter-Korean economic and security dynamics for senior government audiences, translating complex empirical findings into actionable policy recommendations.

Sungkyun Institute for China Studies (SICS)

Seoul, Korea

RESEARCH ASSOCIATE (PROMOTED FROM RESEARCH ASSISTANT)

Sep 2019 - Feb 2023

- Led and contributed to 30 commissioned research projects over 3.5 years, spanning policy research, program management, and bilateral dialogue coordination for ROK government ministries (MFA, MOU, KF) and international institutions; supervised junior research assistants and managed project timelines with budgets ranging from \$11,000-\$77,000 USD; produced sole-authored policy briefs and research reports directly informing senior government decision-makers on Chinese foreign policy and technology competition.
- Conducted primary-source research on Chinese AI development, data governance, and technology competition using Mandarin-language government documents, policy papers, and state media to produce policy-relevant analysis on China's strategic technology policy landscape.
- Coordinated multilateral research exchanges with Chinese and Taiwanese policy institutions including Peking University and NCCU; delivered analytical presentations to ROK government program directors on frontier AI competition, data governance, and technology rivalry; research framework adopted by Korea's Institute for National Security Strategy (INSS) to define national strategic technology policy.
- Served as editor of Sungkyun China Brief (Korean) and Sungkyun China Insight (English), overseeing policy analysis publication on Chinese politics, economics, and foreign policy (2019-2023).

Selected Research

-  **Data Governance and Geopolitics**

Peer-Reviewed Publication

 - Analyzed data as a general-purpose strategic resource in the digital transformation era, developing an analytical framework that redefined data governance as an instrument of interstate strategic rivalry; demonstrated how divergent U.S.-China data governance architectures drive geopolitical competition and create asymmetric advantages in AI development. Framework adopted by Korea’s Institute for National Security Strategy (INSS) to define national strategic technology policy. Cited 7 times; **Lee, I., & Lee, H. (2021).** Data as a Strategic Resource: China’s Data Strategy and the Transformation of U.S.-China Rivalry. *Korea & World Politics*, 37(2), 217–251.
-  **AI Competition as Discourse Competition**

Policy Report

 - Quantified ideological divergence between U.S. and Chinese large language models across multiple languages using multi-model comparative analysis, demonstrating how localized training data and governance regimes shape AI-generated discourse and create asymmetric information environments; assessed strategic implications for AI competition policy and the evolving role of LLM architecture in state-directed influence at scale.
-  **Reassessing the Goals, Strategies, and Targets of China’s Information Operations**

Working Paper

 - Examined Chinese state-backed influence operations targeting Western audiences via systematic open-source collection; applied BERTopic and Poisson/Negative Binomial regression to identify narrative amplification patterns, strategic targeting logic, and campaign-period shifts in messaging strategies; assessed implications for state-directed influence capabilities and the trajectory of AI-enabled information operations.
-  **Semiconductors and the Intensifying U.S.–China Tech Rivalry**

Policy Report

 - Assessed U.S.-China semiconductor rivalry through China’s industrial policy directives, export control dynamics, and workforce development strategies; analyzed how compute supply chain constraints shape the hardware infrastructure underlying large-scale frontier AI development, and South Korea’s strategic positioning within the “Chip 4” alliance.
-  **How Misleading Information Changes Individuals’ Perceptions**

Working Paper

 - Applied topic modeling to disinformation catalogued by Taiwan FactCheck Center to characterize types and patterns of Chinese influence narratives targeting Taiwan; developed a theoretical framework linking disinformation typology to motivated reasoning dynamics across partisan and national identity dimensions.

Education

Indiana University M.S. APPLIED STATISTICS	<i>Bloomington, United States</i> Aug 2023 - May 2026
Sungkyunkwan University M.A. POLITICAL SCIENCE; B.A. POLITICAL SCIENCE; B.A. ECONOMICS	<i>Seoul, Korea</i> Mar 2013 - Jun 2021
Renmin University (人民大学) LAW & POLITICS (GOVERNMENT-FUNDED EXCHANGE PROGRAM AMONG KOREA, CHINA, AND JAPAN)	<i>Beijing, China</i> Feb 2017 - Jul 2017
Republic of Korea Air Force MILITARY POLICE, EDUCATION & TRAINING COORDINATOR	<i>Seoul, Korea</i> Feb 2014 - Feb 2016